

CLOSED: "LOST ON PRICE"

This sale wasn't lost on price.

It was killed by its own data.

Anatomy of a wrong quote, in 11 pieces of evidence.

DATA · STRATEGY · AI

EXHIBIT 01 · THE SCENE

7:40 a.m., at the counter.

- 07:40

A contractor needs a price by noon. Heat pump, 12 baseboards, 12 thermostats.
- 07:52

The heater exists under 2 part numbers. At 2 different prices.
- 08:30

The negotiated price? In the manager's spreadsheet. Not in the ERP.
- 09:15

Compatibility? Buried in a supplier PDF.
- 10:05

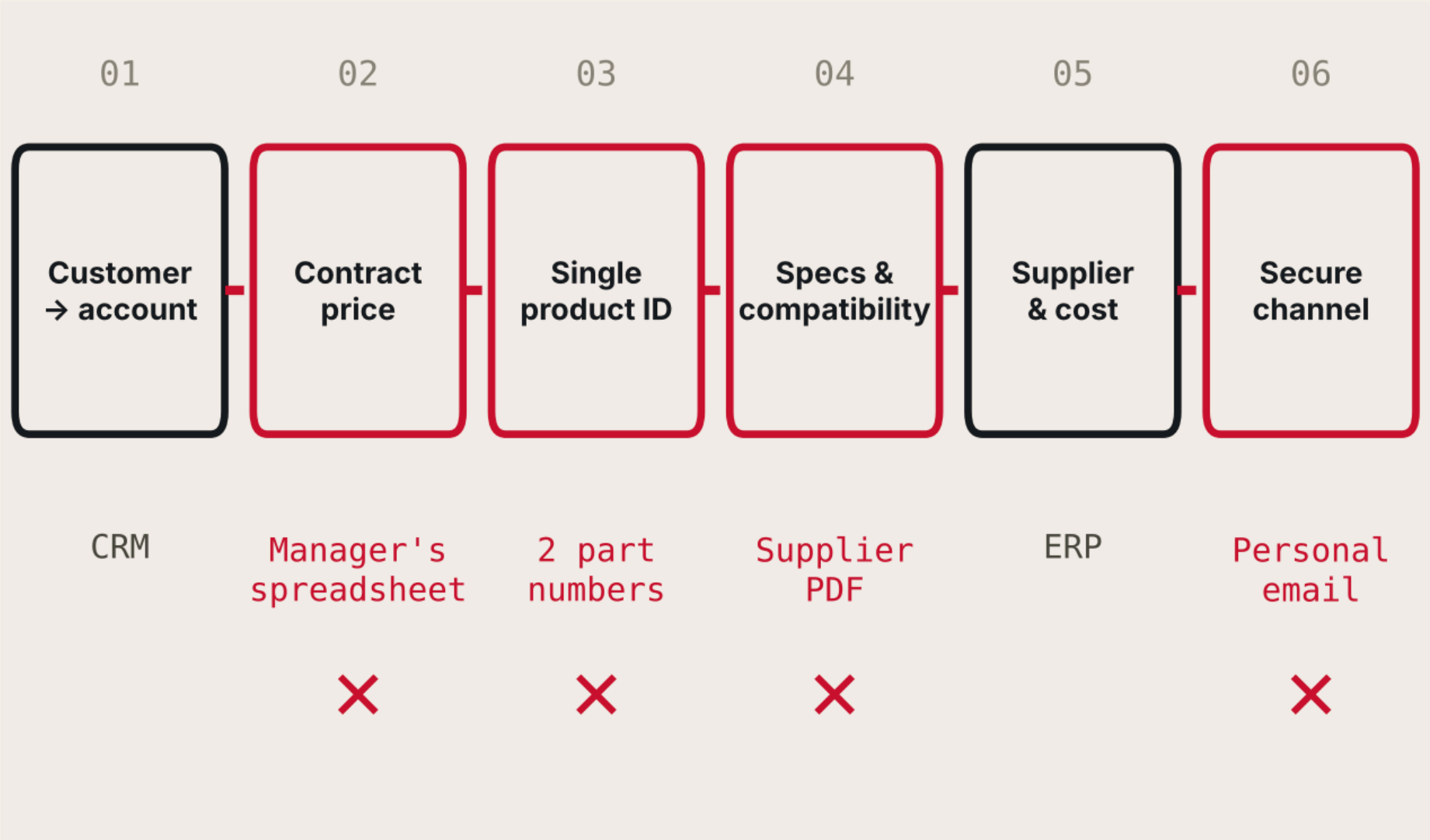
To finish from home, he emails the price file to his personal inbox.
- 10:40

The quote goes out. At the wrong price. The contractor buys elsewhere.

In the CRM: "lost on price." Real cause: 4 of 6 links broken.

EXHIBIT 02 · THE REAL CAUSE

No record was wrong. The links were.



A price is not a field. It's a relationship: this customer, this contract, this product, this supplier, this cost, today.

EXHIBIT 03 · THE WRONG SUSPECT

It's not an IT problem.

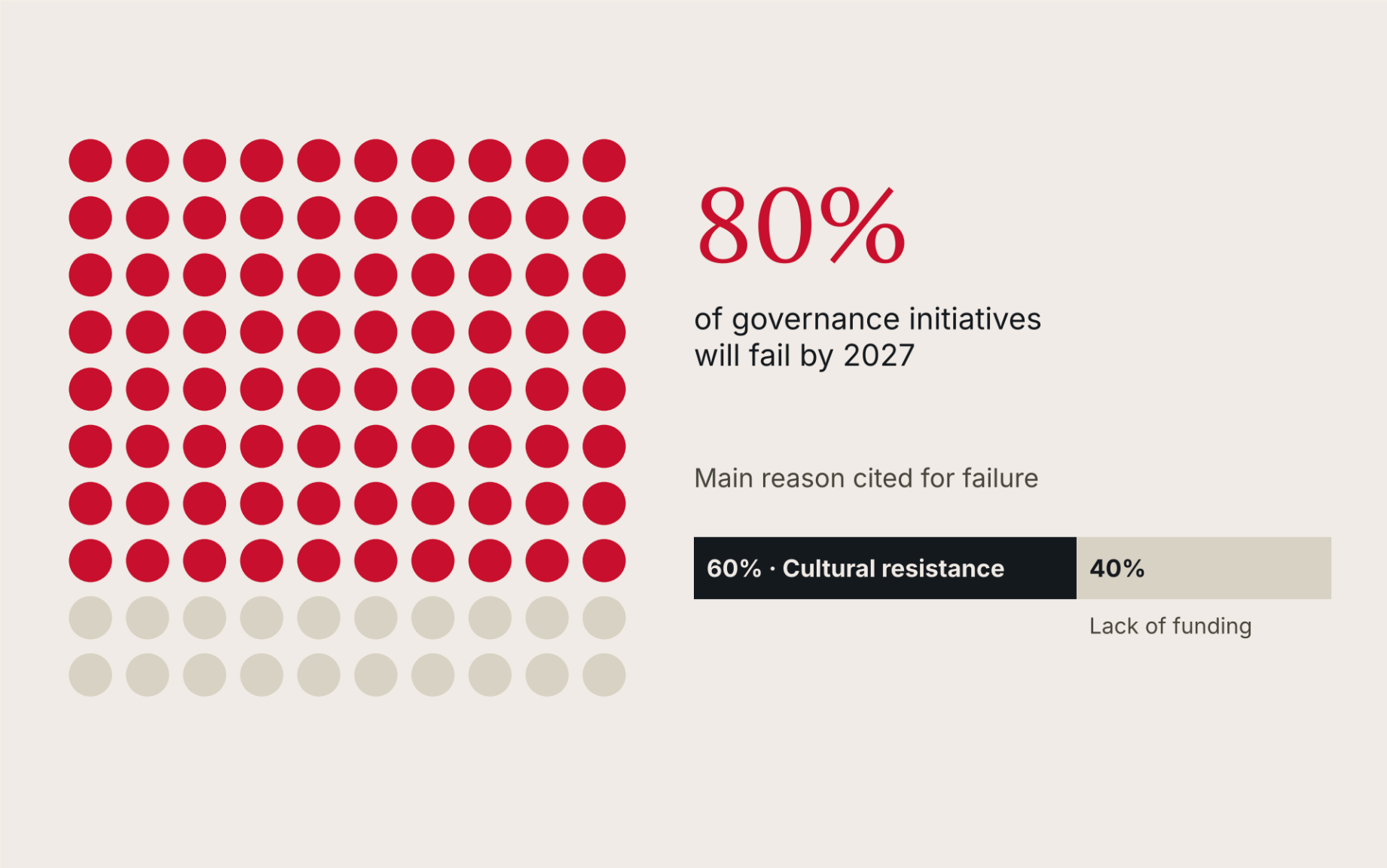
It's a pricing, customer and speed failure.
Commercial outcomes.

Gartner: only **22%** of organizations have defined, tracked and communicated business impact metrics for most of their data use cases.

Source: Gartner, survey of 504 D&A leaders (Feb 20, 2025)

EXHIBIT 04 · THE NAMELESS SUSPECT

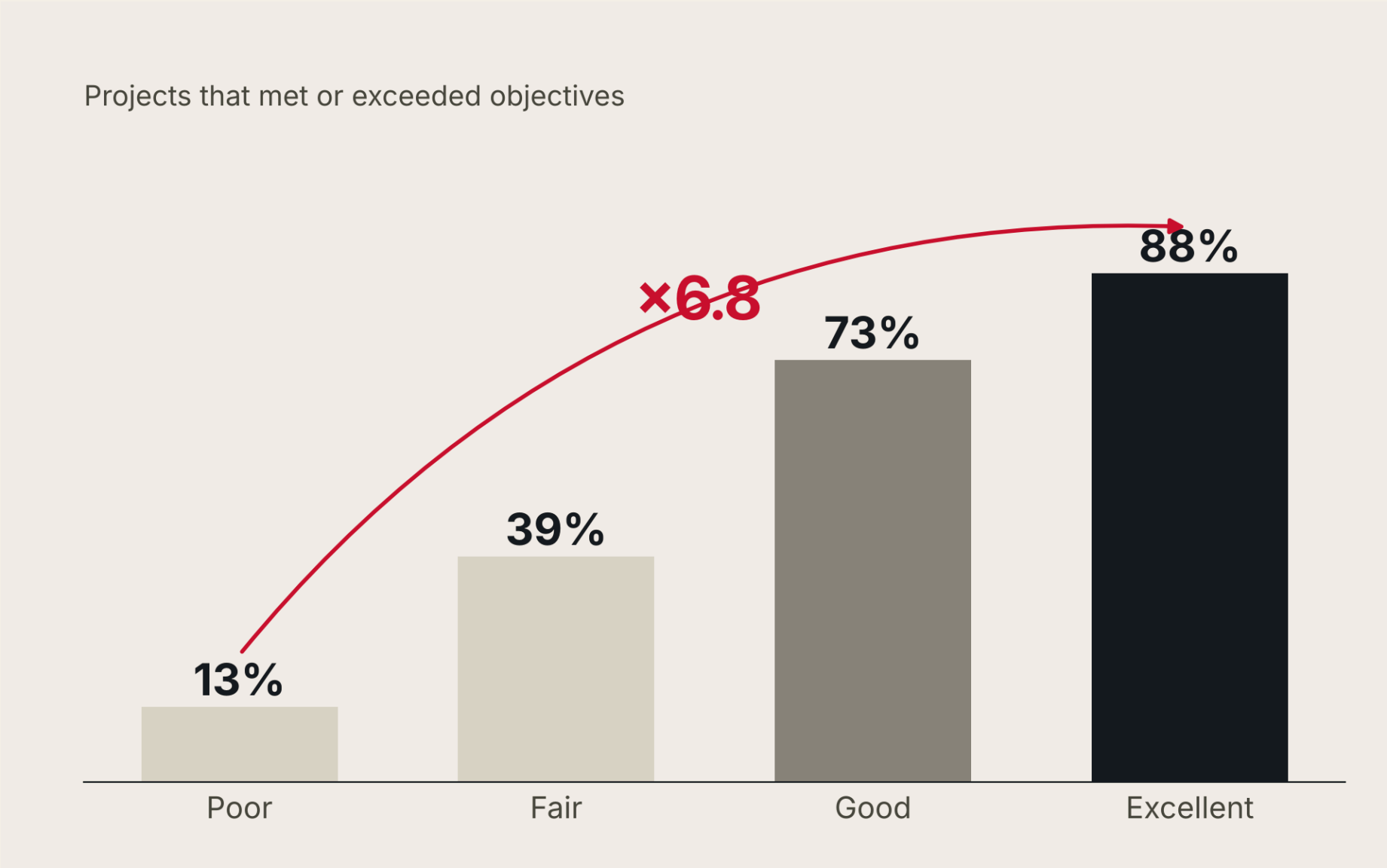
Two prices. Nobody to decide.



Governance isn't a binder. It's the answer to one question: **who decides?**

EXHIBIT 05 · THE MOTIVE

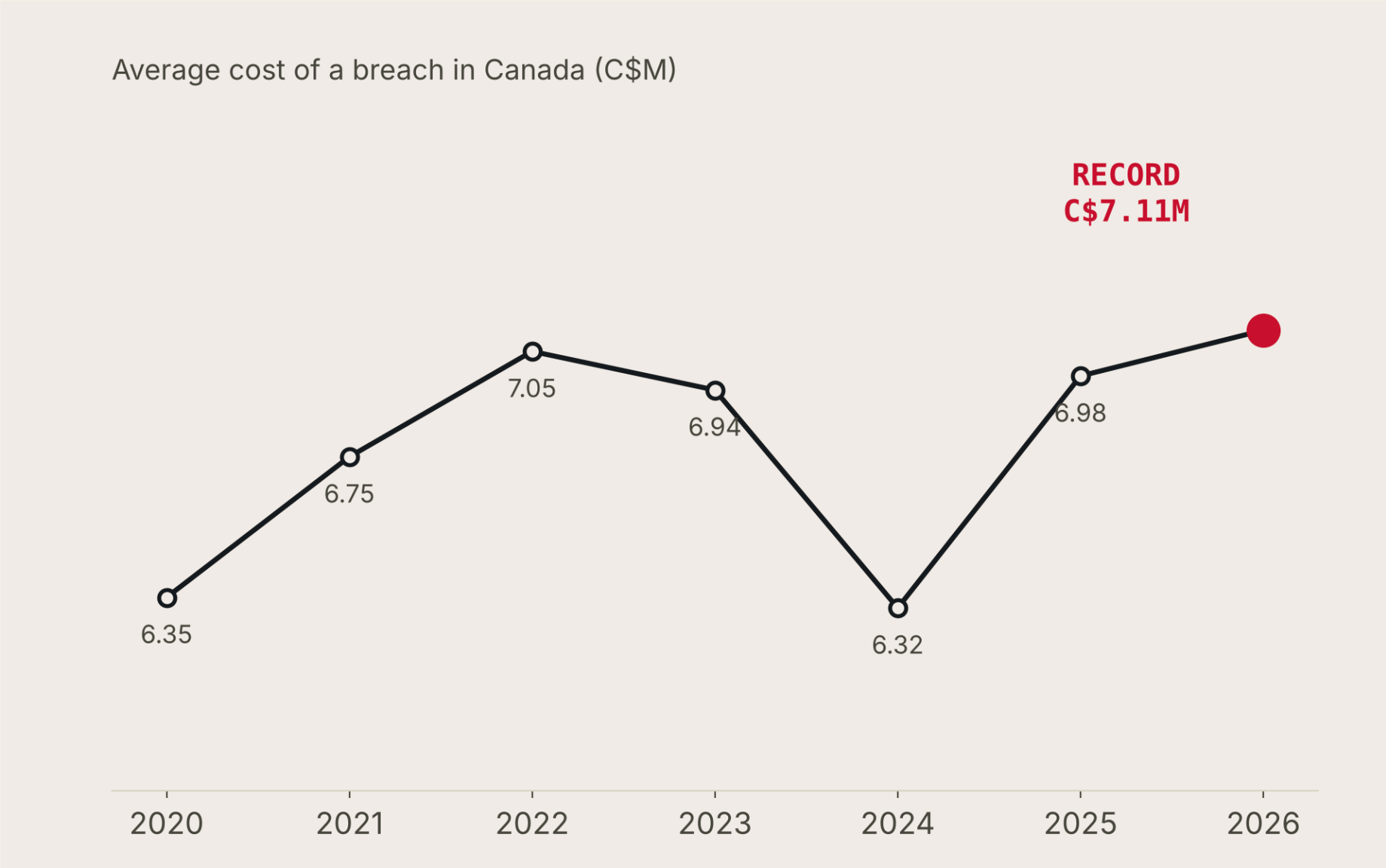
The rep keeps his spreadsheet. And he's right.



He'll only switch when the new data is more reliable than his file.

EXHIBIT 06 · THE BREAK-IN

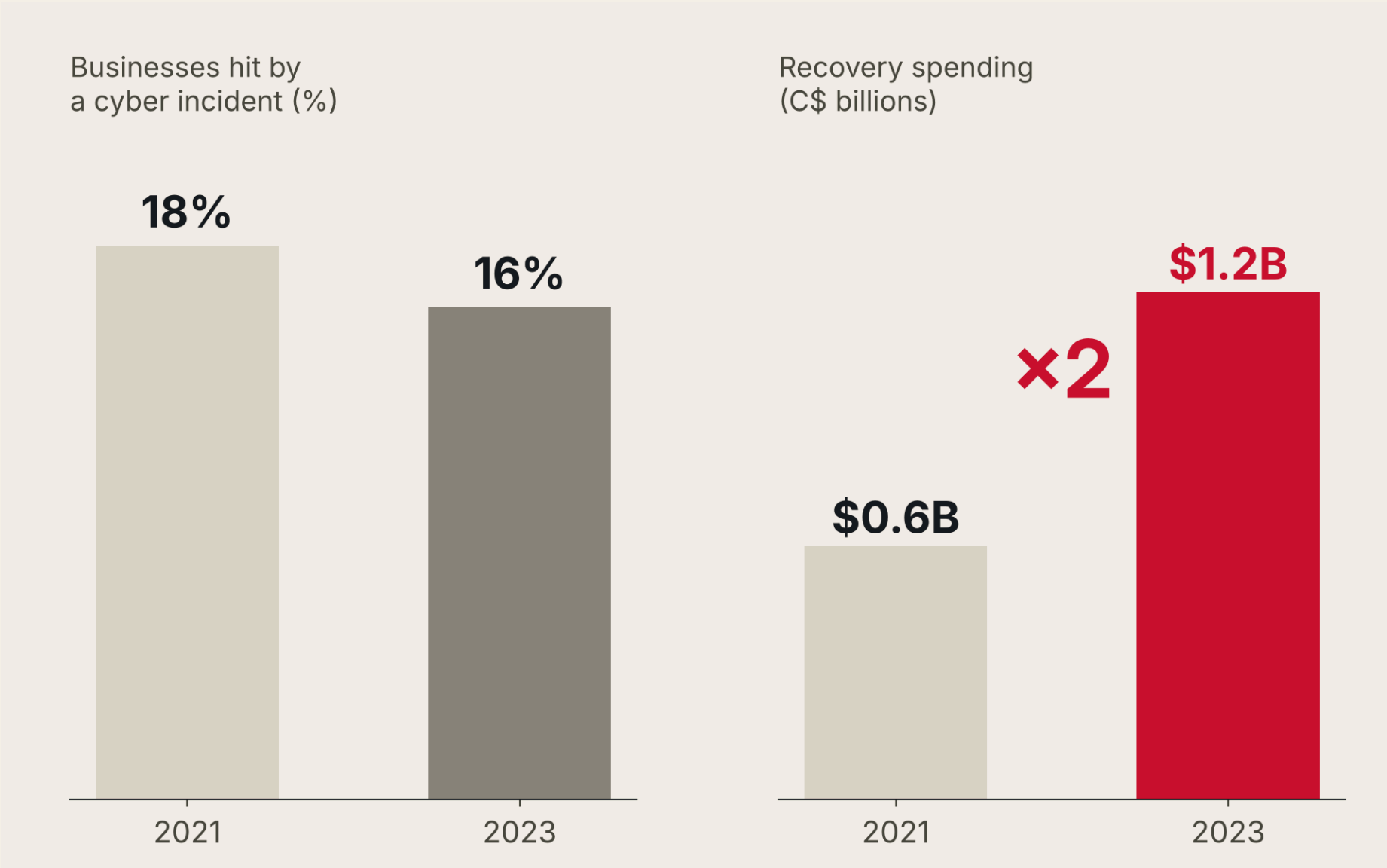
The price file just left in a personal email.



In Canada, a breach now costs **C\$7.11M** on average. A record.

EXHIBIT 07 · THE PARADOX

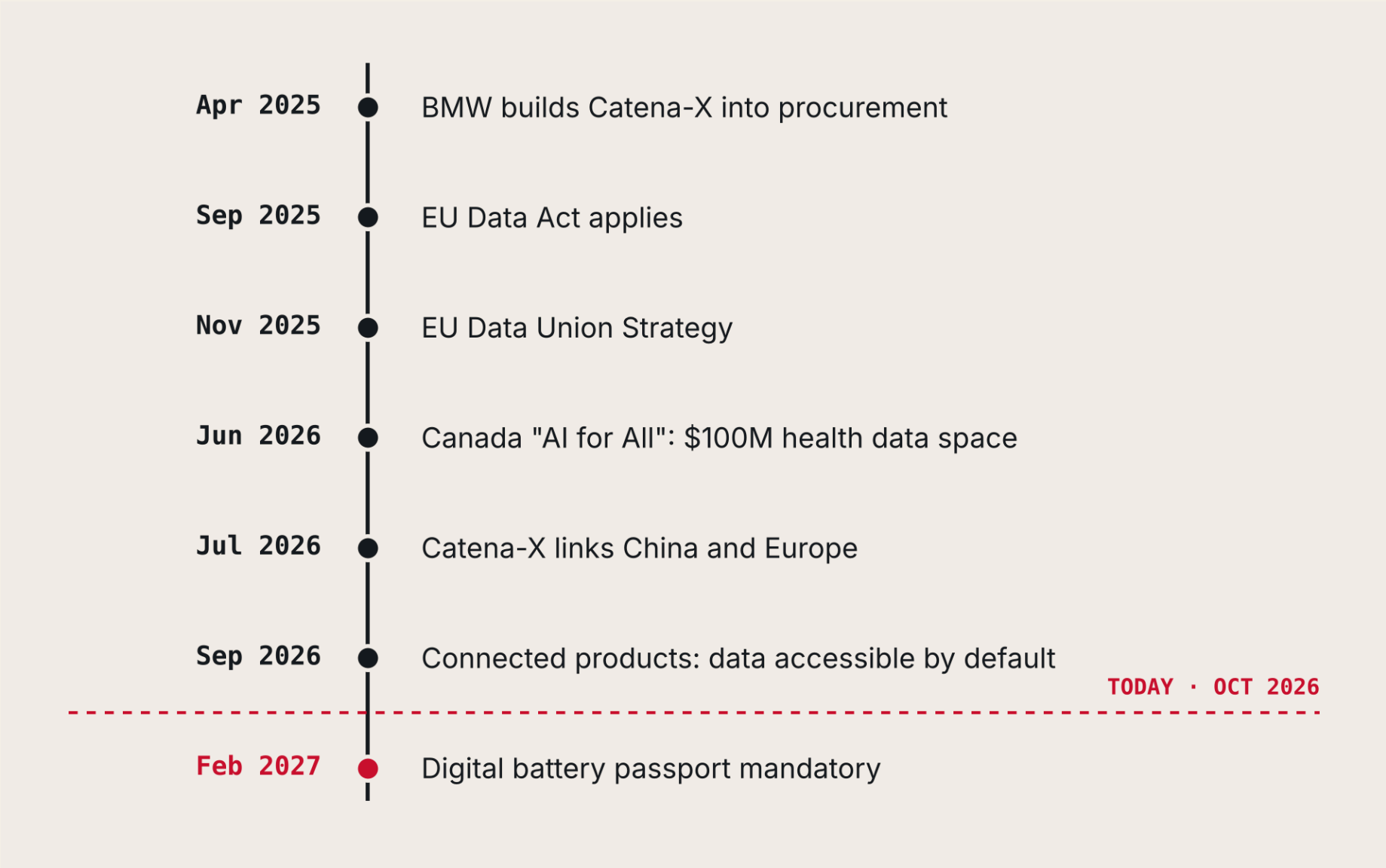
Fewer businesses hit. A bill 2× heavier.



And the #1 cost driver in Canada? **Supply-chain compromise** (+C\$367,899 per breach, IBM 2026).

EXHIBIT 08 · THE CONTEXT

Elsewhere, data is already a condition of market access.



In distribution, the deadline will come from a large customer. Not a law.

Source: European Commission · BMW Group · Catena-X · Gov. of Canada · Reg. (EU) 2023/1542

EXHIBIT 09 · THE REPEAT OFFENSE

AI doesn't fix the lost quote. It industrializes it.

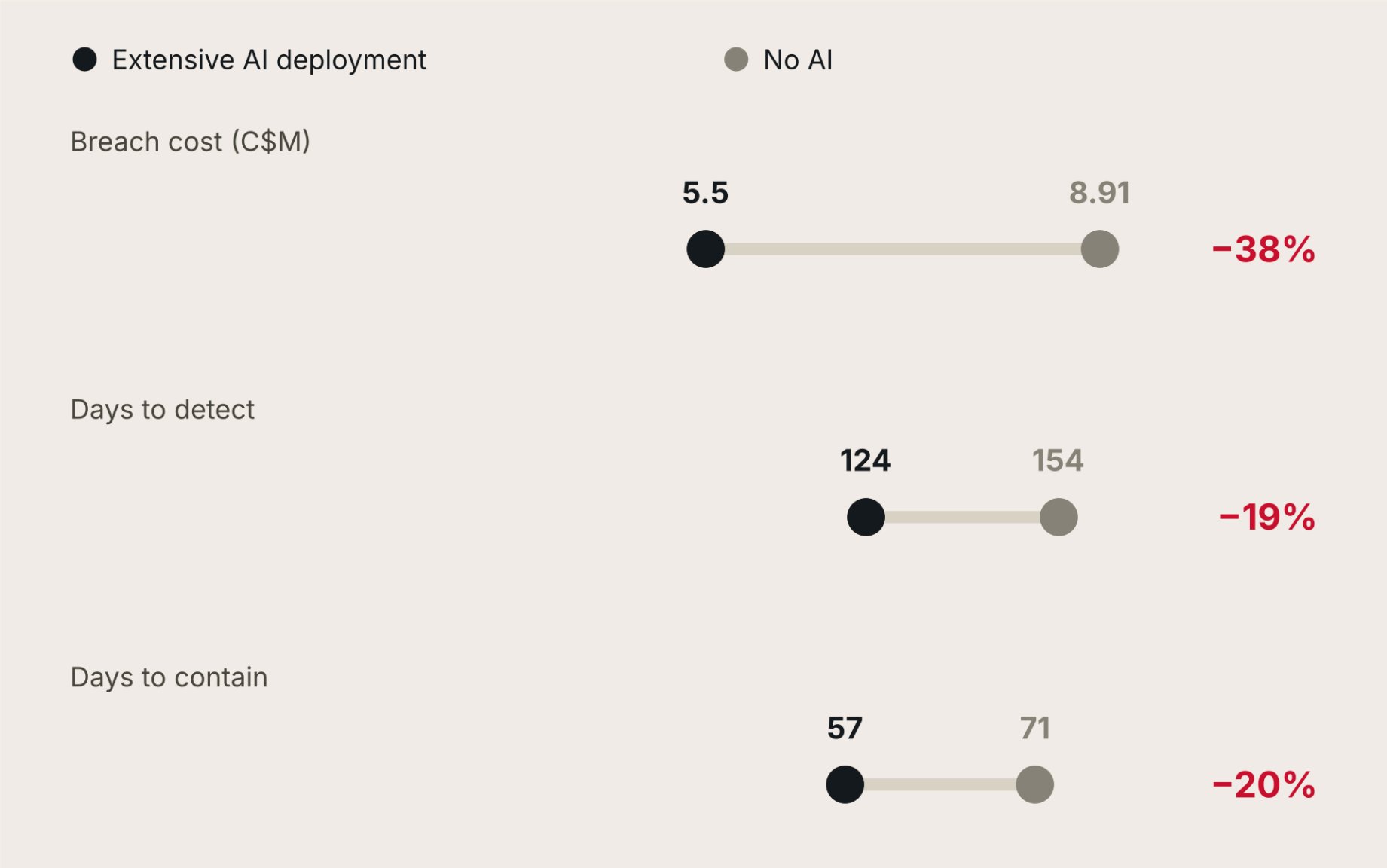
It answers in 4 seconds. It picks one of the two prices with total confidence. It misses the price hidden in the spreadsheet.

And the file? In 2026 it ends up in an unapproved chatbot: shadow AI is involved in **43%** of AI-related incidents.

Source: Analyses of IBM Cost of a Data Breach 2026 (Baker Donelson)

EXHIBIT 10 · THE ANTIDOTE

On a clean foundation, AI pays. For real.



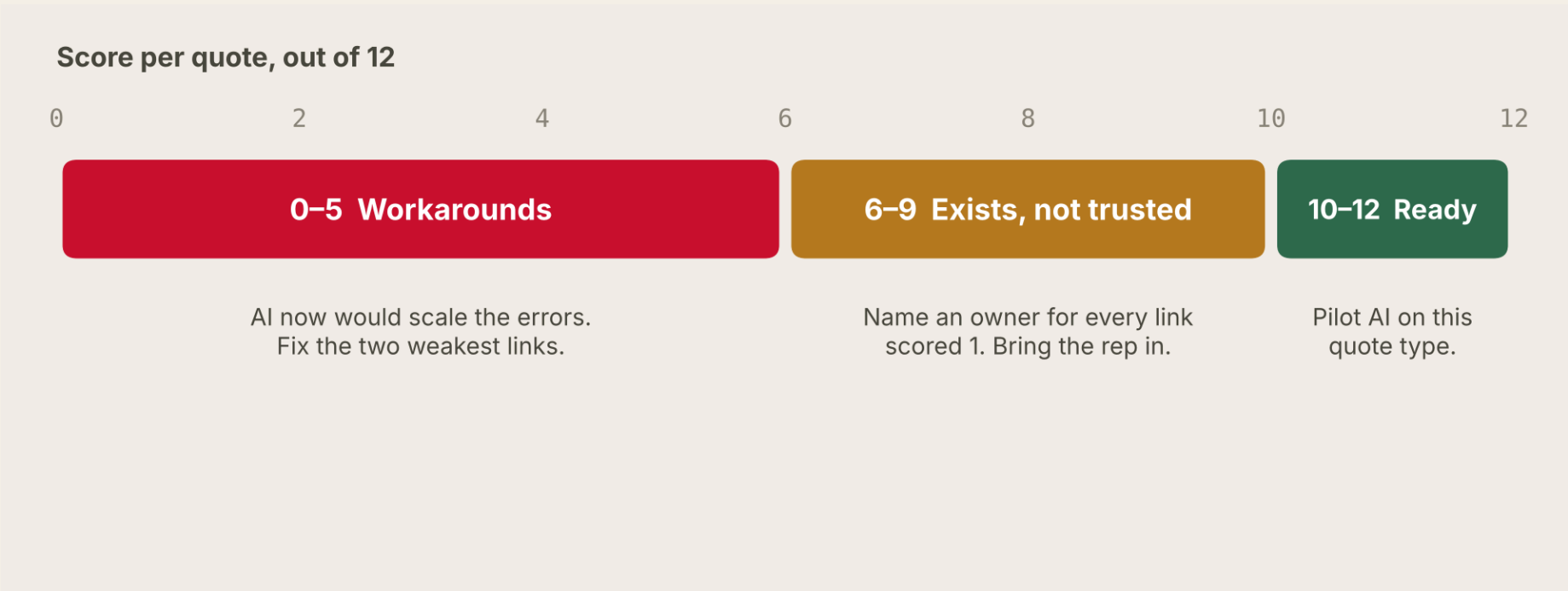
The question isn't "should we adopt AI?" It's "what will it amplify?"

EXHIBIT 11 · THE TOOL

The Quote Trace. 1 hour. 5 lost quotes.

01	Customer → account	0 · 1 · 2
02	Account → contract price	0 · 1 · 2
03	Product → single identity	0 · 1 · 2
04	Product → specs & compatibility	0 · 1 · 2
05	Product → supplier & cost	0 · 1 · 2
06	Quote → secure channel	0 · 1 · 2

0 = broken · 1 = fixed by hand · 2 = trusted. Nobody knows who decides? -1.



How many of your "lost on price" deals actually died of a broken link?

- 01 Pull your last 5 lost quotes.
- 02 Sit down with your best inside rep.
- 03 Run the Trace. Count the broken links.

Comment TRACE and I'll send you the full grid.

 Share with a leader who still thinks it's the price.